

Syllabus

Language Arts Level 2

In the Level 2 course, a captivating fantasy narrative engages students as they practice high-level reading, writing, and grammar skills. When mysterious spells begin troubling the fantasy kingdom of Wondermoore, students are tasked with using their literary know-how to break the spells and restore the magic of the fantasy world. Teaming up with Greenie, a grammar-loving lizard, students hone their grammar skills and effectively complete their spell-busting writing projects.

The goal of AoPS Academy Language Arts courses is to train the intellectual leaders of the next generation by fostering creative problem solving. In our classes, students tackle projects that are framed as interpretation and communication problems: how can we communicate an idea in just the right way? Or, how can we understand complex ideas that are being communicated to us? To solve these problems, students must craft written pieces and oral presentations that demonstrate mastery of the Language Arts skills they learned in class. In this way, our courses help students develop the confidence and advanced literacy skills they need to solve any communication problem they encounter, whether it's in college, in the professional world, or in their own lives.

Time Commitment: This 36-week course includes 105 minutes of in-class instruction and 60-90 minutes of homework each week, corresponding to a full-year course.

Homework: Students should expect to spend about 1–2 hours on homework every week. Homework will include practicing the reading, writing, and grammar skills covered in class, working on ongoing writing projects, and completing reading assignments. Students are expected to read independently throughout the year from assigned novels and nonfiction books. Students will take weekly reading quizzes on the course homepage to ensure that they are keeping up with the reading.

Exams: Students will take a short exam at the end of each unit. Each exam covers the grammar skills, vocabulary, and key reading and writing concepts taught throughout the unit.

Content:

Week	Topic	Week	Topic
1	Unit 1 Introduction, Informational Text	19	Unit 3 Introduction, Fairy Tales
2	Bullet Points and Simple Sentences	20	Identifying Lessons
3	Maps and Setting Vocabulary	21	Powerful Proclamations
4	Text Boxes and Compound Sentences	22	Hooks and Persuasive Voice
5	Headings and Subheadings	23	Reasons and Supporting Details
6	Glossary and Suffixes	24	Conclusions and Quotations
7	Title and Contents Page	25	Call to Action
8	Editing and Punctuation	26	Editing and Homophones
9	Creature Report Presentations!	27	Fairy Tale Announcement Day!
10	Unit 2 Introduction, Letters	28	Unit 4 Introduction, Plot
11	Character Analysis and Adjectives	29	Story Elements
12	Character Analysis and Transitions	30	Building a Character
13	Creating a Paragraph	31	Narrative Planning
14	Summarizing	32	Drafting Scenes
15	Point of View	33	Climax and Resolution
16	Proofreading and Adverbs	34	Revising with Sensory Details
17	Editing and Apostrophes	35	Editing and Commonly Misspelled Words
18	Pen Pal Letter Celebration!	36	Fantasy Story Festival!

The course is divided into four project-based units:

Unit	Description	Common Core Standards	Core Skills or Concepts
1 Creative Informational Text	After studying examples of various informational text features, students create an informational text of their own – a multi-page creature report complete with a table of contents, creature description, and glossary. Book: <i>My Encyclopedia of Very Important Things</i>	RF 2.3D, 2.4 RI 2.1-2, 2.5-6, 2.10 W 2.2, 2.4, 2.5, 2.10 L 2.1-2.2	Navigate nonfiction texts with purpose and understanding; discern between nouns and verbs; compose clear sentences with proper punctuation; identify and use conjunctions to create compound sentences; use suffix understanding when reading and writing words
2 Descriptive Letters	As part of an engaging pen-pal program centered around mythical characters, students employ their character analysis skills to carefully choose pen pals, before drafting letters to their newfound friends. Book: <i>Soupy Saturdays</i>	RL 2.6 RF 2.3A, 2.3D, 2.4, 3.4B W 2.4-5, 2.10 L 2.2, 3.1A	Make inferences based on evidence; write paragraphs with an opening and closing; correctly format a letter; use the -ly suffix to determine the meaning of adverbs and create adverbs; determine point of view; identify a word's part of speech
3 Persuasive Announcements	Students explore effective techniques for persuading an audience as they craft multi-paragraph announcements about their favorite fairy tales. Book: <i>The Other Side of The Story</i>	RL 2.2, 2.6 RF 2.4 W 2.1, 2.4-5, 2.10 L 2.2, 3.1A	Hook readers by using a persuasive voice and punctuation for effect; use transition words and phrases to connect ideas; organize ideas into paragraphs; properly punctuate direct quotes; present written work to an audience of peers
4 Story Writing	After studying narrative elements such as setting, character, and plot, students are assigned the exciting task of crafting their own fantasy stories. Book: <i>Mighty Meg</i>	RL 2.2 RF 2.4 W 2.4-5, 2.10 L 2.2	Incorporate elements of a story (setting, character, problem, and solution) in an original narrative, revise writing for purpose and reader's understanding, include sensory details in writing, correctly use past tense verbs and maintain verb tense agreement

To interpret the Common Core Standards column on the table above, visit the Common Core ELA website at www.corestandards.org/ELA-Literacy.